



**PRIME** Minister Mark Carney, with Trade Minister Dominic LeBlanc and chief negotiator Janice Charette.

# Tariffs deepen trade war with Canada

Ottawa responds after the U.S. imposes a 50% tax on \$20 billion worth of products.

By PAUL WISEMAN AND ROB GILLIES

WASHINGTON — The United States and Canada, traditionally close allies with a long history of co-operation, fell deeper into a trade war Saturday marked by angry recriminations and new tariffs that are expected to raise prices for products in both countries.

The U.S. imposed 50% tariffs on \$20 billion worth of Canadian products, prompting Canada to respond, setting Sept. 8 as the start of its retaliatory penalties. Each side blamed the other for the collapse of negotiations in Washington late Friday.

President Trump's import taxes will hit about 5% of what Canada ships to the United States every year, on products from hockey sticks to tongue depressors. They went into effect at 12:01 a.m. Saturday as a deadline to reach a trade deal passed.

Prime Minister Mark Carney said that Ottawa would respond with targeted tariff protection for industries exposed to the new U.S. duties, including some steel products. He also mentioned the dairy, appliance, agricultural equipment, pulp and paper and electronics sectors.

No further talks were planned. Whatever the eventual outcome, a loss of trust seems one of the earliest casualties.

Carney accused Washington of using "economic integration as a weapon" and said "its signature was written in pencil." Resorting to the language of battle, he said his country had been "attacked" by the new American tariffs. "You're at war when you get attacked," he said, adding that Canada had the reserves, resilience and plan to respond.

Trump's chief trade negotiator, Jamieson Greer, said the U.S. was compelled to act after a year of retaliation by its longtime partner.

"We've said enough, and [See Tariffs, A5]

## A durable alliance is deeply altered

Canada and the U.S. had one of the world's closest relationships before the trade war. **WORLD, A3**

# Ebbing water, grim findings

As the water level at Lake Mead has plunged to a historic low, more human remains are emerging from the depths of the nation's largest reservoir.

It is an eerie trend that began about four years ago, with some remains belonging to drowning victims and others likely murder victims.

The latest discovery came on Aug. 16 at Boulder Beach on the western part of the Lake Mead National Recreation Area in Nevada, according to national park officials.

"At this time, there is no indication of criminal activity," park officials wrote in an email response to The Times. "The investigation remains ongoing and no additional information is available."

It is the latest set of human remains discovered at Lake Mead in recent years. [See Mead, A10]

As Lake Mead continues to shrink, more bodies are being discovered in the reservoir

By RUBEN VIVES



**A RECEDING** Lake Mead is shown at Lake Mead National Recreation Area near Boulder City, Nev.

## COLUMN ONE

# The cartel's man in the sky

How a shadowy pilot called Jando climbed from smuggling drugs to flying El Chapo's sons

By KEGAN HAMILTON

On a July afternoon in 2024, a private plane carrying three men from Mexico touched down at a small airport a few miles west of El Paso. Federal agents were waiting on the tarmac to greet them, handcuffs at the ready.

The first to disembark was Joaquín Guzmán López, a son of the infamous Sinaloa cartel leader "El Chapo." Pudgy and dark-haired with a stubbly beard, he had just turned 38 and was wanted by U.S. authorities for working with his three brothers — known collectively as Los Chapitos — to smuggle tons of fentanyl, methamphetamine and cocaine.

Behind him was his septuagenarian godfather, Ismael "El Mayo" Zambada, a

longtime partner of El Chapo who co-founded the Sinaloa cartel and had a \$15-million bounty on his head.

And then there was the pilot. Although his passengers were among the world's most notorious drug traffickers, the aviator who flew them across the border was almost a complete unknown — so much so that while the others were arrested immediately, he was allowed to walk free and return home to Mexico.

Since then, however, interviews and court documents reveal that he was a key member of the Chapitos organization — essentially the commander of the cartel's air force. And he could soon play a role in bringing down other major cartel lead- [See Jando, A4]

# 'Proteinmaxxing' filling L.A. plates

By NAVA RAWLS



**A BUTCHER** prepares chicken at Fountain Grains & Greens, a counter-service diner in East Hollywood.

It's lunchtime at Fountain Grains & Greens in East Hollywood, a counter-service restaurant where customers increasingly prefer their rice and vegetable bowls piled high with hunks of chicken or steak.

More and more, diners are leaning into "protein-maxxing," the viral health trend that promotes increased protein intake with the goal of boosting metabolism, decreasing appetite and increasing muscle mass.

As orders flood into the restaurant via online food delivery services and a walk-up window, a butcher slices [See Trend, A11]

# Democrats prep for potential interference in the midterms

Messaging from the Trump administration leads to creation of defensive battle plans.

By KEVIN RECTOR AND JUSTINE MCDANIEL

Big-city mayors are giving poll workers panic buttons in case election skeptics question their work. County and state officials are gaming out responses to immigration raids near voting centers.

Lawyers for Democratic states and civic groups are pre-writing legal challenges to ballot seizures. And Democratic aides in Washington are preparing members of Congress to push back in the court of public opinion against any baseless claims of voter fraud in competitive districts.

Across California and the nation, civic organizations, voting rights advocates and Democratic leaders are preparing for a raft of potential actions by the Trump administration to interfere in, subvert or deny November's midterm vote.

President Trump, an election denier for years, has without evidence described the U.S. election system as badly corrupted by fraud and dangerously vulnerable to both domestic and foreign interference.

He has said he would do "anything necessary" to have "honest elections," and

has tried since returning to office to unilaterally rewrite the rules for voting nationwide and wrest control of elections from the states through executive orders and other administrative measures.

Now, he has declined to rule out additional and unprecedented steps to force his will on the November election, including through emergency declarations and military deployments, and in February suggested Republicans should simply take over voting in blue states.

Election experts say there is no evidence of widespread voter fraud in American elections, despite Trump's allies searching for years.

Much of the work to resist any Trump interference or power grab is being done quietly to avoid revealing too much of the strategy to the Trump administration or stoking unnecessary fear among voters.

It is designed to match what Trump's opponents see as his three-part "interference playbook" — to "deceive" voters before the election, "disrupt" the vote itself and "deny" any unfavorable results after, said Justin Vail of Protect Democracy, a prominent litigant against the administration.

"The threats are real," Vail said, "but the preparation is larger and more coordinated than ever before."

The scenarios being [See Midterms, A8]

# Raman scrutinized over role in tackling L.A.'s homelessness

Critics say mayoral candidate failed to lead key committee with needed urgency.

By NOAH GOLDBERG

Nithya Raman has made Los Angeles' struggle to combat homelessness a key plank in her mayoral campaign, yet her own record on the matter has itself become an issue with her ouster as head of the City Council committee seeking solutions to the crisis.

Mayor Karen Bass is at the helm of the city's battle against homelessness, but since 2023 Raman has been the second-most powerful official as chair of the City Council's Housing and Homelessness Committee. That changed this month, when council President Marqueece Harris-Dawson, a key Bass ally, split the com-

mittee in two and removed Raman as its chair, effective Sept. 1.

Raman claims that politics were at play, casting her removal as a hit job for her decision to challenge Bass. Harris-Dawson disputes that, saying Raman failed to lead the committee with the urgency needed to combat L.A.'s enduring homelessness crisis.

"The committee is behind in excess of more than 100 issues," said Harris-Dawson in an interview. "There are very serious decisions to make over what happens with homelessness. We needed someone who could focus on that and get it done and get it done quickly and show ability to build consensus."

Beyond the dispute over Raman's leadership of the committee, there are clear policy disagreements between the mayor and the council member over the [See Raman, A10]

## He's still going strong after 50 years on beat

Eric Sondheimer has grown into a prep sports reporting legend, Bill Plaschke writes. **SPORTS, D1**

## Bitcoin and gold rally out of slump

Recent action by Trump and the Treasury help lift cryptocurrency and the precious metal to a strong week. **NATION, A8**

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## Exoneration was years in making

Guy Miles served almost two decades for a Fullerton robbery he didn't commit. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

## Dodgers interest Soon-Shiong

The Times' owner says he would be a buyer if club is put on the block by Walter. **SPORTS, D8**

**Weather**  
Toasty conditions. L.A. Basin: 97°/72. **B8**

